

Custom E-Mail Domains with Azure Communication Services (ACS) in Soundbite.AI

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This article describes the process for setting up a custom e-mail domain for Soundbite.AI to send e-mail.

Background

By default, e-mail notifications are sent via the address "NoReply@Soundbite.AI". For the purposes of improved security and user experience, it's possible to use [Azure Communication Services \(ACS\)](#)  to send these e-mail with a custom domain on behalf of your organization. This requires a Microsoft Azure subscription for your organization, following these setup instructions, and will cause the [cost for notifications](#)  to be borne by the subscription holding the ACS instance.

To configure your own custom e-mail, then you need to do the following two things:

1. Create and configure an E-Mail Communication Service and associated parent ACS instance in Azure
2. Configure your Soundbite organization in Soundbite studio to use the newly configured information from step one

Creating ACS Resources

To create the necessary ACS resources, please follow this sequence of Microsoft Azure tutorials on learn.microsoft.com :

1. [Quickstart: Create and Manage Email Communication Service resource in ACS](#)  will guide you through how to create the e-mail sender resource, which provides the capability to connect to your custom domain and send secure e-mail on your behalf. This resource is then connected to a parent ACS instance (in step 3) which enables consuming the resource to send e-mail.
2. [Quickstart: How to Add Custom Verified Domains to Email Communication Services](#)  will guide you on how to securely connect your domain to the Email Communication Service resource you made above. It is recommended you follow the instructions to add [SPF and DKIM to authenticate your custom domain](#) . Verifying with SPF and DKIM requires the ability to configure TXT and CNAME DNS records for your sending domain. Many organizations find it helpful to make a separate domain from which they send soundbite e-mails to simplify the IT process for getting the DNS records configured. *Please consult with your IT/Security department to understand more on how DNS configuration can be achieved within the guidelines of your organization.*
3. [Quickstart: How to Connect a Verified Email Domain to ACS Service Resource](#)  to create and connect a parent Azure Communication Service (ACS) instance. This will provide management of the e-mail resource and is where connection string information for connecting to the e-mail service is available. You MUST connect a parent ACS instance to your e-mail service in order to allow Soundbite to connect.
4. [Quickstart: Create and Manage Communication Services Resource](#)  has a section of the article portraying how to access the connection string for an ACS instance. It will be necessary to access these resources

For those who would prefer a video introduction to these topics, you might try the following videos that provide a technical perspective for developers on the service. They are general-purpose introductory

walkthroughs on the services, but they, more importantly, capture the Azure Portal UI as of June 2023, which many people might find a more useful orientation than trying to read through the articles above:

- [Send an Email With Azure Communication Services by Microsoft 365 Developer on YouTube](#)  will walk you through the ACS e-mail capabilities with an intended audience of a developer making a custom application. It is NOT necessary for you to make a custom application; however, this is the fastest technical introduction to the concepts in the services and may be helpful for demonstrating ACS to anyone curious about the service itself.
- [Create an Azure Communication Services Resource in Azure](#)  will walk you through the use cases for ACS and the configuration of a parent ACS instance and how its user interface works.

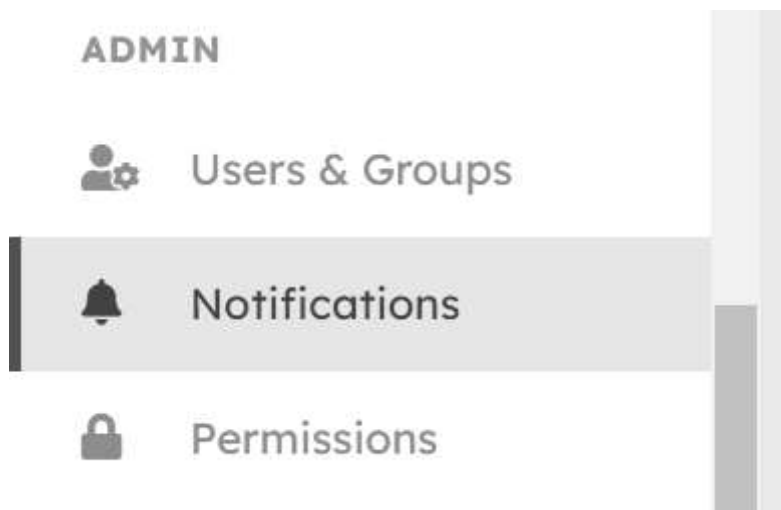
You may want to simply skip around in the videos to the demos where they demonstrate the user interface. Again, these videos are general-purpose education for developers on ACS. You do NOT need to make a custom application to send e-mail as in these videos, you just need to create and configure the ACS and related e-mail as above to move on to the next step of configuring Soundbite to consume the connection string and your preferred e-mail address on your new secure custom e-mail domain.

Configuring Custom ACS Instance in Soundbite Studio

Now that you have an existing ACS instance with an e-mail service attached, copy the connection string for the ACS instance. It should have the following format:

```
endpoint=https://[ACS Instance Name].communication.azure.com/accesskey=[Random Key]
```

As a Soundbite admin, go into Soundbite Studio and find the "Notifications" link in the Admin section of the left nav:



There will then be a card in the Notifications view that has three fields:

- Connection String - The string you just copied from the parent ACS instance, based on the instructions above
- From E-Mail - The "From" e-mail for the custom domain. Must be a valid entry in the list of addresses for the Azure E-Mail Service configured above

- From Name - The "From" name, which will appear as the source of the e-mail in most e-mail clients. This must match the entry for the e-mail entered in the second field

 **Soundbite (Preview) Custom E-Mail Notifications Settings**
Enabling custom senders for e-mail notifications from Soundbite via Azure Communication Services

Reset

 Save

After entering the initial values, you can click the "save" button to persist your custom e-mail configuration. While these settings are in effect, e-mails will flow through your custom e-mail domain instead of coming from the standard "NoReply@Soundbite.AI" e-mail address. Congratulations! You've now upped your odds of successful delivery while maintaining security best practices - and amped up your branded user experience along the way!

If you have an existing value for your custom e-mail configuration, then you will also see a "Reset" button which enables you to clear the custom e-mail settings.